

Docstrings

Docstrings are multiline comments that appear either at the top of a module's *.py* source code file or directly following a `class` or `def` statement. They provide documentation about the module, class, function, or method being defined. Automated documentation generator tools use these docstrings to generate external documentation files, such as help files or web pages.

Docstrings must use triple-quoted, multiline comments rather than single-line comments that begin with a hash mark, `#`. Docstrings should always use three double quotes for its triple-quoted strings rather than three single quotes. For example, here is an excerpt from the *sessions.py* file in the popular `requests` module:

```
❶ # -*- coding: utf-8 -*-

❷ """
    requests.session
    ~~~~~

    This module provides a Session object to manage and persist settings across
    requests (cookies, auth, proxies).
    """
    import os
    import sys
    --snip--
    class Session(SessionRedirectMixin):
        ❸ """A Requests session.

        Provides cookie persistence, connection-pooling, and configuration.

        Basic Usage::

            >>> import requests
            >>> s = requests.Session()
            >>> s.get('https://httpbin.org/get')
            <Response [200]>
            --snip--

        def get(self, url, **kwargs):
            ❹ r"""Sends a GET request. Returns :class:`Response` object.
```